

Outlook

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Follow-up: the ATM pattern may be customer error or coordinated testing

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Cyber wants to know whether repeated PIN failures, balance enquiries and cash attempts form recognisable sequences before a card is blocked. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if normal forgotten-PIN behaviour dominates?
2. What evidence would instead support that a balance enquiry followed by rapid withdrawals marks higher risk?
3. How do we rule out that specific terminals see repeated card testing?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use December 2022 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards which sequences should become monitoring rules and which would create unacceptable false positives. A useful output would be a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included.

Use ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories. One caution: There is no CCTV, device fingerprint or complete card-network feed, so classify behavioural patterns rather than confirmed attacks.

Regards